PAYMENT REVERSAL POLICY

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Document purpose: This synthetic policy defines the expected handling and customer communication for failed payments where the customer's account has been debited. It is created as test content for the Enterprise Knowledge & Support Copilot project.

1. Scope

This policy applies to payment transactions processed through the payment gateway when a transaction fails or is confirmed as unsuccessful, but the customer's bank account, card, UPI account, or other original payment method shows a debit. It covers reversal timelines, support verification, escalation, and customer communication.

2. Failed payment and reversal timeline

For this synthetic project policy, the reversed amount is generally credited to the customer's original payment method within 5 business days after the payment provider confirms that the transaction has failed and the reversal has been initiated.

The five-business-day period is the expected timeline used by this project's knowledge-base test cases. It is not a guarantee that every bank or payment method will complete processing at exactly the same time. Support must communicate the applicable status and avoid promising a specific credit date unless confirmed by the provider.

3. When the reversal process begins

The reversal process begins only after the payment provider or the gateway's authoritative transaction record confirms that the payment failed and that the transaction is eligible for reversal. A customer-facing error screen alone is not sufficient proof of the final payment state. Support personnel must verify the payment ID and provider reference before advising the customer that a reversal has been initiated.

4. Customer communication

When a customer reports a debit for a failed payment, support personnel should acknowledge the concern, explain that the transaction status is being verified, and provide the expected five-business-day reversal timeline only after the failed status and reversal initiation have been confirmed. If the reversal is still pending with the provider, communicate that status clearly and do not describe it as completed.

5. Verification and support workflow

Support personnel should complete these checks before closing or escalating a case:

1. Collect the payment ID, transaction reference, transaction date, amount, and payment method.
2. Check the authoritative server-side payment state and provider response. Do not rely only on a client-side screen.
3. Confirm whether the transaction is failed, pending, reversed, or in another provider-defined state.
4. If failed and debited, verify reversal initiation and record the provider reference or status.
5. Tell the customer the amount is generally credited to the original payment method within 5 business days from confirmed initiation.
6. Record checks, timestamps, provider responses, and customer communication in the support ticket.

6. Cases exceeding the expected timeline

If the amount has not been credited after 5 business days from confirmed reversal initiation, the customer should contact support again or the existing case should be escalated. Support must re-check provider status, verify the original payment method, and raise a provider follow-up using the payment ID and transaction reference. Do not mark the case resolved until the status is verified or the next action is documented.

7. Exceptions and cautions

A transaction that remains pending is not automatically eligible for the failed-payment reversal workflow. A captured or successful payment must be handled through the applicable refund or cancellation process, not described as a failed-payment reversal. If the provider reports a different status or timeline, record that information and communicate it accurately.

8. Example response for support agents

> “We have verified that your payment failed and that the reversal has been initiated. The amount is generally credited back to the original payment method within 5 business days. If it is not credited within that period, please contact us with your payment ID so we can follow up with the payment provider.”

9. Knowledge-base test facts

Question: How long does a failed payment reversal take?
Expected answer: The reversed amount is generally credited to the customer's original payment method within 5 business days after the provider confirms failure and reversal initiation.
Retrieval keywords: failed payment, reversal, debited, 5 business days, original payment method.

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